6

BASIC STITCHES

6.1 INTRODUCTION

Just like it is necessary to first make a foundation before erecting a building, the basic stitches form the foundation of sewing. These stitches can also be used to make the garment more beautiful and attractive. It is essential for all beginners to know about the basic stitches. Let us find out more in this lesson.

6.2 OBJECTIVE

After reading this lesson, you will be able to do the following:

- use various kinds of stitches;
- demonstrate the use of these stitches to teach others;
- make your garments more beautiful and attractive by using these stitches.

6.3 MEANING OF STITCHES

The mark of thread left on a piece of cloth when a threaded needle is moved in and out of the cloth is known as a 'stitch'.

6.4 NEED FOR STITCHES

1. To join two pieces of cloth together
2. For neatness and for finishing.

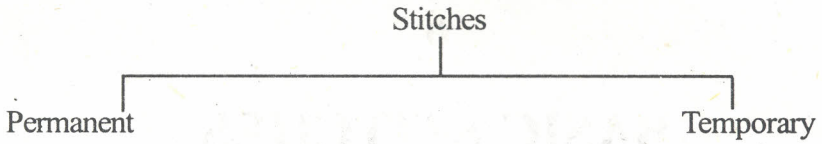
3. To get a good shape.

4. To control the cloth.

6.5 TYPES, USE AND METHOD OF MAKING STITCHES

There are two types of stitches :-

a) Permanent b) Temporary



a) Permanent Stitches

These stitches are left in the garment and are not removed after the garment is ready. Hence they are known as permanent stitches. These are of the following types :-

i) Quilting

This stitch is used to sew together two or more than two layers of cloth. The needle is inserted diagonally into the cloth and brought out in the other direction. Quilting is done from the wrong side of the cloth, as a result of which only a very small stitch is seen on the front and slightly larger zig-zag stitches are seen on the reverse. The stitch is used to set the inner lapels in a coat. The stitch can be made either by hand or a special quilting machine can be used for the purpose.

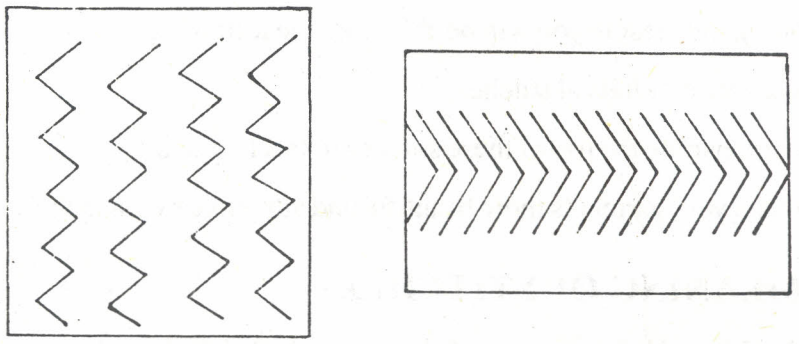


Fig 6.1

ii) Back Stitch

This stitch is used to join two pieces of cloth together. Earlier this was done by hand but now it is done with the help of a sewing machine. To make this stitch, the threaded needle is passed through the layers of cloth to the other side and after leaving 2-3 threads, it is

passed back again. To make the next stitch the needle is inserted behind the first stitch. The process is repeated, leaving equal spaces between stitches.

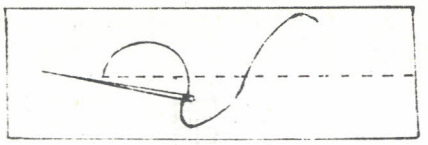


Fig 6.2 Back stitch

iii) Fine Stitch

This is made very like the running stitch. The only difference is that the stitch appears like a pin point on the right side and as a slightly larger stitch on the wrong side.

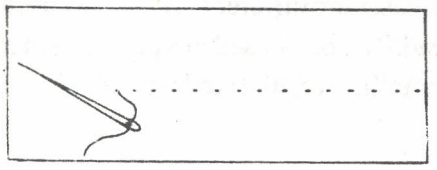


Fig 6.3 Fine stitch

iv) Hemming stitch

This stitch is used to fasten a raw edge which is to be turned in while hemming. The needle is inserted into the single fabric first, two threads are taken up and then the needle enters the very edge of the fold, where its drawn out. All the stitches are made parallel to each other.

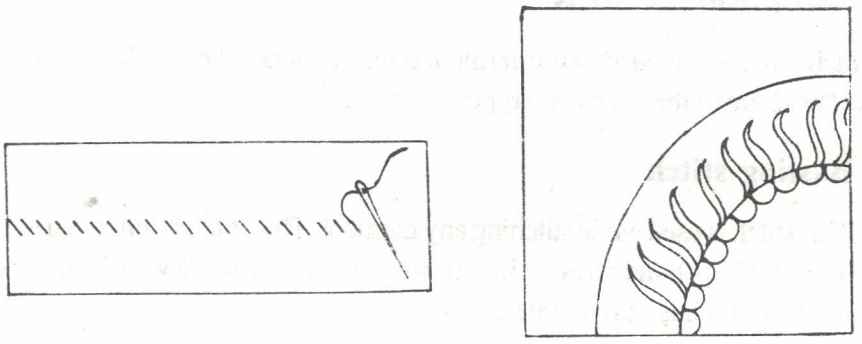


Fig 6.4 Hemming

v) Buttonhole stitch

This stitch is used for making buttonholes, eyelets and other decoration on garments. To make this stitch, the needles is inserted half a point behind the cut edge of the buttonhole and the thread is looped over the needle. The stitch is worked all round the cut buttonhole and the raw edges are thus secured. One end of the buttonhole is made straight.



Fig 6.5 Buttonhole stitch

vi) Hook and eye

Hook and eye are used to close the open edges of a garment, e.g. in a blouse or in a pant. But the hooks used in both cases are different. The hooks used in a blouse have two holes and its eye is made of thread. The hook used in a pant has three holes and it has a metallic eye. The hooks and the metallic eye are fixed with a chain stitch.



Fig 6.6 Eye

(b) Temporary Stitches

These stitches are removed after the garment is ready. Hence they are known as temporary stitches. These are of the following types:

i) Basting stitch

This stitch is used while stitching any garment. This stitch is longer on the right side and smaller on the wrong side. It is used to control silky and slippery fabrics. Basting stitch is of two types:-

- even basting stitch
- uneven basting stitch

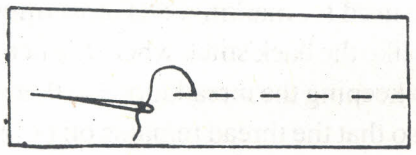


Fig 6.7 Even basting stitch

ii) Diagonal basting stitch

This stitch is particularly used where basting is to be done in two places, close to one another. This allows one to work faster. It is specially used for linings and interlinings. The stitch is made by inserting the needle and drawing it out diagonally.

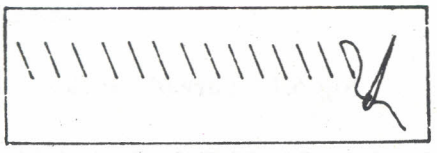


Fig 6.8 Diagonal basting stitch

iii) Running stitch

This stitch is very like the basting stitch. The stitches are smaller and even in size on both sides. This stitch is used to make gathers in a garment, to draw up the cloth for smocking and to make small, delicate curves in a garment.

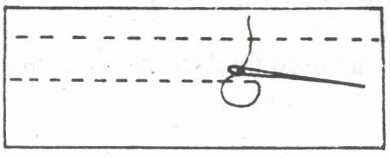


Fig 6.9 Running stitch

iv) Thread Mark

This is also known as the 'loop stitch'. It is used to transfer the marking from one layer of fabric to another. It is generally used on fabrics where the tracing wheel or chalk can not be used for marking. It is most often used on woollen fabrics. The stitch is made like the back stitch where the needle is inserted from behind and then drawn up keeping the thread loose so that a loop is formed. This loop is later cut in half so that the thread remains on both layers of fabric.

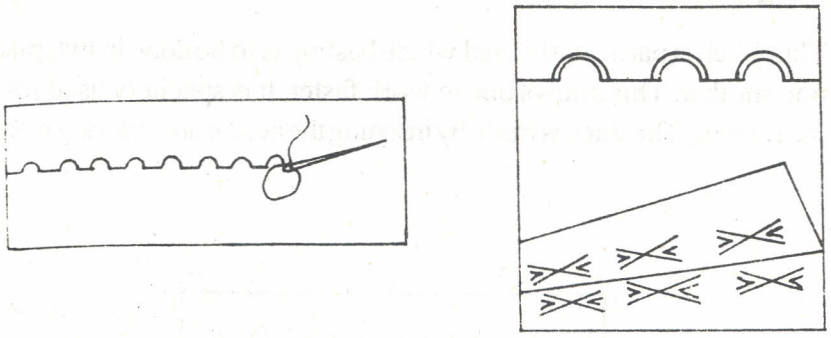


Fig 6.10 Thread Mark

INTEXT QUESTIONS 6.1

State whether the following are true or false:-

i) Fine stitch is used for making button holes.

ii) The quilting stitch is used to sew together two layers of cloth.

iii) The same kind of hooks are used in pants and blouses.

iv) The fine stitch is used on shirt collars.

v) The running stitch is used for smocking.

6.6 DECORATIVE STITCHES

Various decorative stitches are used for decorating garments. Decorative stitches are as follows:-

i) Blanket stitch

This stitch is generally used to bind the edges of a blanket, hence the name 'blanket

stitch'. This stitch can be made in various ways, like straight, V-shape, etc. This stitch is also used as a decorative stitch on garments. It is made by keeping the thread under the needle and then pulling the needle through.

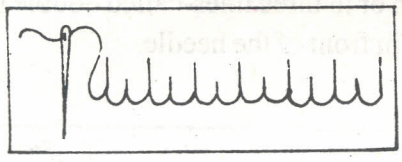


Fig 6.11 Blanket stitch

ii) Herring-bone stitch

The herring-bone stitch is worked from left to right in two lines alternatively. The stitch on the bottom line lies between two stitches on the top line and vice-versa. This is used to secure the edges in woolen fabrics which are too thick to be turned in for hemming. The width of the stitch should not more than 2 threads. This is also used to decorate children's garments or to neater and decorate edges of handkerchiefs.

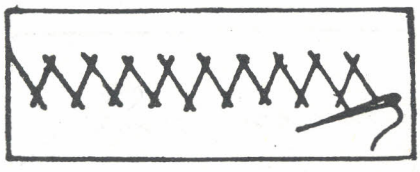


Fig 6.12 Herring-bone stitch

iii) Fish bone stitch

This stitch looks like the bones of a fish and is thus called the fish bone stitch. The stitches are linked to each other. These stitches are used on thick fabrics and on the gathers of children garments, etc. The stitch is made by keeping the thread in front of the needle.

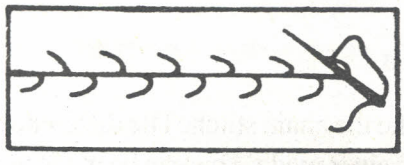


Fig 6.13 Fish bone stitch

iv) Feather Stitch

This stitch looks like the feathers of a bird. It is basically a loop stitch made by taking diagonal stitches in the same direction. This is used to decorate bed sheets, tablecloth and children's garments. Feather stitch can be made in two lines - called single feather stitch or in three lines-called double feather stitch. It is made by keeping the thread in front of the needle.

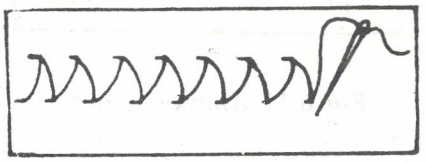


Fig 6.14 Feather stitch

v) Stem stitch

This stitch is also known as reverse back stitch. The stitch is taken from the wrong side of the fabric. It gives the appearance of a stem which is why it is called the stem stitch. It is used to embroider the stem of flowers etc. The stitch is made by taking back stitches while keeping the thread towards oneself.

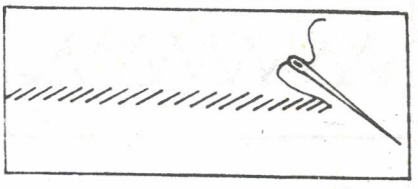


Fig 6.15 Stem Stitch

vi) Chain Stitch

This stitch looks like a chain and is thus called a chain stitch. It is made by looping the thread over the needle. The needle is inserted in the same hole from which it came out, thus making a chain of loops.

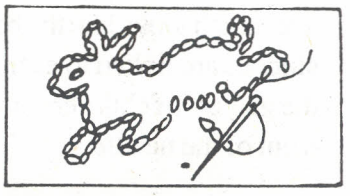


Fig 6.16 Chain Stitch

vii) Lazy Daisy Stitch

This is also made like the chain stitch. The difference is that individual loops are tired down and no chain is made. This can be made in various colors and the stitch is generally used to embroider flowers, etc.

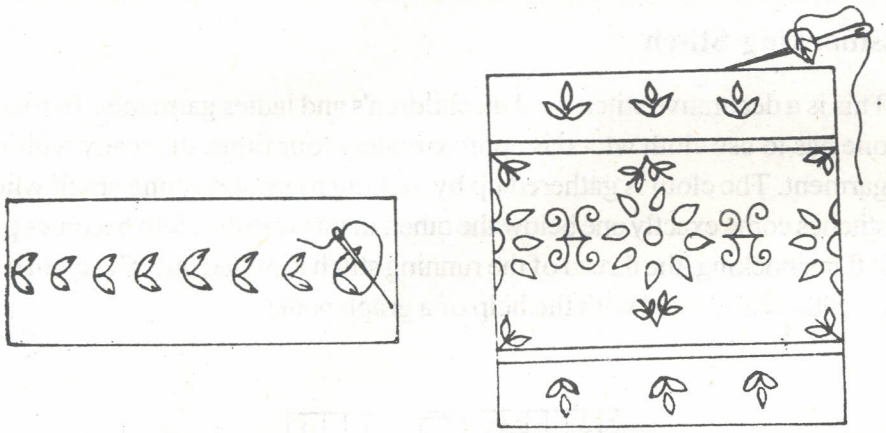


Fig 6.17 Lazy Daisy Stitch

viii) Satin Stitch

This stitch has been named after the satin cloth. It is soft like satin. It is made by taking stitches very close to one another. It is tied off after finishing for extra neatness. While doing the satin stitch care should be taken to make even stitches.

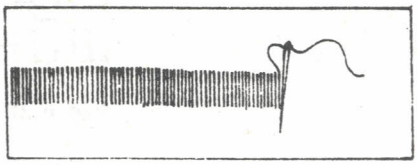


Fig 6.18 Satin Stitch

ix) Cross Stitch

This is also referred to as the 'matti stitch'. This is made by taking a diagonal stitch overlapped by another diagonal stitch in the opposite direction. It is generally made on matti cloth, casement, etc. It is also used to decorate garments and on hanky edges.

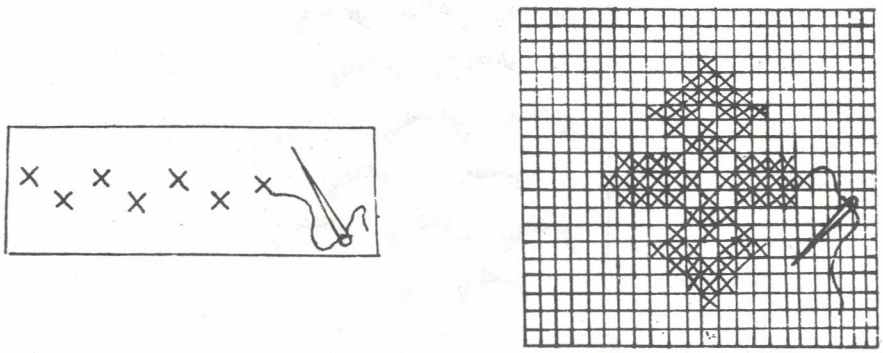


Fig 6.19 Cross Stitch

x) Smocking Stitch

This is a decorative stitch used on children's and ladies garments. To make this, one has to use cloth which is approximately four times the ready width of the garment. The cloth is gathered up by making rows of running stitch where the stitches come exactly one below the other. In this way the cloth becomes pleated. After smocking, the thread of the running stitch is pulled out. The cloth can also be gathered/pleated with the help of a graph paper.

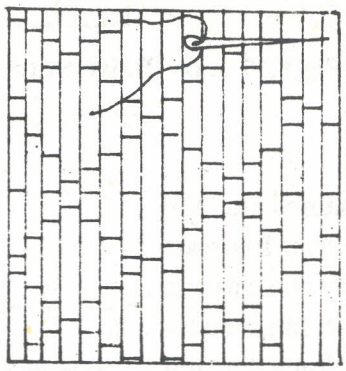


Fig 6.20 Smocking Stitch

xi) Eyelet stitch

This stitch is used to decorate the bottom of petticoats or the sleeves of sari blouse or to make a hole for putting a draw string in a garment, etc. To make this, a hole is made by using either a poker or a nail and then filling all round using the satin stitch.

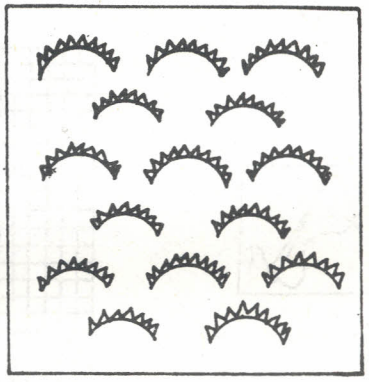


Fig 6.21 Eyelet stitch

6.7 WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt about the meaning of stitch, need, types of stitches, their uses, the method of making them along with the decorative stitches used to decorate and beautify garments.

6.8 TERMINAL EXERCISE

1. Which are the stitches used for tacking and where are they used?
2. What will you do to prevent the edges of a fabric from fraying?

ACTIVITY

Use any five decorative stitches to decorate a garment and explain how they are made.

6.9 ANSWERS TO INTEXT QUESTIONS

6.1 i) False ii) True iii) False

iv) False v) True.